

it comes to performance. Be it playing games, be it watching content, or be it using the camera or other features, the smartphone just doesn't know how to slow down.

I also played a lot of games on the OnePlus 12 and not only does the smartphone consistently maintain frames and shows no signs of lag or anything, but it also doesn't heat up. OnePlus has used a Dual Cryo-velocity vapour chamber which seems to have worked with the OnePlus 12. The company claims that this is the largest vapour cooling chamber with over 3 times the heat dissipation and since we are not able to teardown the smartphone and check the size for ourselves, the OnePlus 12 doesn't heat up easily.

Battery is also good. While playing games, the OnePlus 12 optimises battery very well and the smartphone only lost about 4 percent of the battery while playing Call of Duty Mobile for 15 minutes. A YouTube video stream of 30 minutes on 2160p HDR resolution drained only 5 percent of the battery, and in the video loop test the smartphone ran for about xx minutes.

The best part this time around is that OnePlus has brought back wireless charging with the OnePlus 12 and as someone who mostly uses wireless charging at home, I absolutely love when flagships like this enthusiast-level device come with wireless charging since it takes away the need for keeping the charger handy at all times.

CAMERA

Now, coming to the camera, this is the first time a OnePlus flagship's camera has stood tall amid the tough competition from the Samsung's and Vivo's of this year. The camera is capable since there is brilliant hardware, but the software optimisation on the OnePlus 12 is something that isn't the best.

The hardware has not been tuned too well and the point and shoot from the OnePlus 12 with the primary shooter is just average. While the camera is good and if you know your way around, you can click some absolutely stunning



photos from the OnePlus 12. However, with just point and shoot, the results aren't very true to life.

But well, that is not a problem anymore. Because by the time I finished my testing of the OnePlus 12 and started writing this very review, the OnePlus 12 had received an update with the Master Mode. This new feature takes away all the processing done by the OnePlus algorithm and puts the output control in the user's hand, giving them more freedom to not only adjust the exposure, but also the saturation, contrast, sharpening, vignette, and even bring few "Pro mode" options to the default camera.

This basically lets users click photos in the styles that they may edit their pictures in. Super cool and super useful for a camera that has all the potential, but is limited by the lack of tuning or algorithms.

Further, this is also the first time we are getting a periscope telephoto lens on a OnePlus smartphone so you can click many perspectives with the 1x, 2x, 3x, and 6x zoom levels, and the telephoto also enables a 120x digital zoom, which is not good in terms of the quality of the 120x images, but it is there so you can zoom into distant objects and at least make out what is what.

VERDICT

So the OnePlus 12 is a proper OnePlus device. The smartphone's looks, to its display, to the performance, to even the battery and charging - everything reeks of OnePlus. On top, this year we get some added goodies like the periscope

telephoto lens or the wireless charging, or for those who are into it, the marble finish won't require you to wait for a limited edition OnePlus device.

But there are shortcomings of course. For example, the camera isn't tuned to its full potential and most of the time after the

latest update, I found myself using the Master Mode to take pictures. This also isn't the best performing phone of the year already, and the size may be a bit too big for many users, since we are seeing a bit of bulking as compared to last year's OnePlus 11. But overall, this is as flagship as a smartphone gets and the OnePlus 12 makes for a superb all-rounder device for its price.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 164.3 x 75.8 x 9.2 mm (6.47 x 2.98 x 0.36 in) | Weight: 220 g (7.76 oz) | Build: Glass front (Gorilla Glass Victus 2), glass back (Gorilla Glass), aluminum frame | SIM: Single SIM (Nano-SIM) or Dual SIM (2x Nano-SIM, eSIM, dual stand-by) or Dual SIM (2x Nano-SIM, dual stand-by) | IP65, waterproof and dustproof | Display Type: LTPO AMOLED, 1B colors, 120Hz, Dolby Vision, HDR10+, 600 nits (typ), 1600 nits (HBM), 4500 nits (peak) | Display Size: 6.82 inches, 113.0 cm² (~90.8% screen-to-body ratio) | Display Resolution: 1440 x 3168 pixels (~510 ppi density) | Display Protection: Corning Gorilla Glass Victus 2 | OS: Android 14, OxygenOS 14 (International), ColorOS 14 (China) | Chipset: Qualcomm SM8650-AB Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 (4 nm) | CPU: Octa-core (1x3.3 GHz Cortex-X4 & 3x3.2 GHz Cortex-A720 & 2x3.0 GHz Cortex-A720 & 2x2.3 GHz Cortex-A520) | GPU: Adreno 750 | Internal: 256GB 12GB RAM, 256GB 16GB RAM, 512GB 16GB RAM, 1TB 16GB RAM, 1TB 24GB RAM | UFS 4.0 | MAIN CAMERA: 50 MP, 64 MP, 48 MP | Features: Hasselblad Color Calibration, Dual-LED flash, HDR, panorama | Video: 8K@24fps, 4K@30/60fps, 1080p@30/60/240/480fps, Auto HDR, gyro-EIS, Dolby Vision | SELFIE CAMERA: Single (32 MP, f/2.4, 21mm (wide), 1/2.74", 0.8µm) | Features: Auto-HDR, panorama | Video: 4K@30fps, 1080p@30fps, gyro-EIS

CONTACT

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